

SURREY SCOUT

DECEMBER, 1977

No. 368

International

International Letter of Introduction

Have you considered asking me for one of these to use during your business and holiday trips abroad? How much they help when making contact with Scouting overseas can best be illustrated by a visit my wife and I made to Malta recently. Not only were we well received at the Island H.Q. but also most warmly at the meeting of the Sliema Group. We had to go all that way to meet a fellow Scouter from Surrey, Ted Thomson, G.S.L. 1st Haslemere, who turned-up at the same Troop Meeting! The Scouts of Malta are pleased to welcome visiting Troops/Units but space is limited so early notice is necessary. If you have ideas of going there do get in touch with me.

Advisory Service

That is why my role is as A.C.C. (International) and it is designed to keep routine matters away from the Overseas Department at Baden-Powell House. So if you have any queries of an International nature do first approach me, if you go to them they will only re-direct you to me!

International Opportunities

News of further happenings are now available:

3rd Asia Pacific Jamboree

An invitation to the 3rd Asia-Pacific Jamboree to be held on Oamaru, New Zealand, from 4th - 11th January, 1978, is extended to Scouts and Venture Scouts (12-19 years), Adult Leaders (21-35 years).

XVth World Jamboree in Iran - 1979

It is anticipated that information about the XVth World Jamboree in Iran from 15th-23rd July, 1979, will be circulated in November, 1977. The theme will be **CULTURAL DEVELOPMENTS** and we are working on a **JOIN-IN-JAMBOREE** programme.

Norway Y.M.C.A. - Scouts of Norway

A National Jamboree will be held at Verdal in the District of Trøndelag near the town of Levanger, 60 km north of Trondheim from July 30th to August 5th, 1978. Cost is Norwegian Kr. 300 - excluding travel. The minimum age is 11 and participants should have earlier experience of camping.

Home Exchange Visits

The Overseas Department would like to hear from anyone who might be interested in home exchange visits with Danish and/or Greek Scouts/Venture Scouts in the summer of 1978/79.

Visit Kandersteg with your Scouts in 1978 from £66 per person

The Youth Hostel Association Travel are offering a very reasonably priced package deal for British Scouts/Venture Scouts travelling to the International Scout Centre at Kandersteg in Switzerland. It is inclusive of return air and rail fares, plus ten nights accommodation. Good kitchen facilities are available for self-catering. Similar arrangements can be made for individuals.

Apply for a YHA '78 brochure from me or Mr. Venner, YHA Travel Agency, 29 John Adam Street, London WC2N 6JE, Tel: London (01) 839 1722.

The Explorer Belt Scheme

The Explorer Belt - most Venture Scouts have heard of it but few attempt to gain it. This might reflect a lack of adventure. More likely it is due to a lack of understanding as to what is involved. There is nothing mystical about the Explorer Belt Scheme, nor is participation in it restricted to an elite. The Scheme is simply intended as an encouragement to you to complete what should prove to be the most enjoyable, challenging and rewarding activity you undertake as a Venture Scout - an expedition of exploration and discovery which brings you to some real understanding of a foreign country, its people and their way of life.

You may participate in the Scheme in either of two ways. You can apply to the Overseas Department at Headquarters to take part in a 'Standard' expedition, in which case you will join a party of Venture Scouts from all over Great Britain and travel, under adult leadership, to a specific country on specific dates. Alternatively, you can opt for the Independent Explorer Belt Scheme a "do it yourself" event which allows you to go where you want, when you want. Ask me for a pamphlet which gives full details of how to participate.

JOHN HAVERS

Venture Scouts

Andoventure III

This is the name of the County Expedition to Andorra next year. The detailed publicity went to every Unit with the November "Surrey Scout" so there is no need to repeat it here. Although it is called a County Expedition this is not strictly correct. All County does is to provide Units with the camp site, help with information and arrange travel. It is up to each Unit to plan its own expedition. If you have not seen the circular contact me as soon as you can because you must make the initial booking by the 20th of this month.

Army Youth Teams

I have just received a letter from the Army telling me that Army Youth Teams will be disbanded on the 5th April 1978 on the grounds of economy. This is a great shame because the service we have received from the teams at Guildford and Caterham over the last 16 years has been excellent. I should like to place on record the thanks of the Venture Scouts of Surrey to the many teams that have served us so well.

Christmas 1977

It appears to me that most Venture Scouts in Surrey live full and active lives surrounded by family and friends. I hope that Units will remember that everyone is not so fortunate and that Christmas can be a very lonely time for many people, especially the elderly. If you are looking for your Christmas good turn there are many opportunities in this area.

Jan and I send you all our very best wishes for a happy Christmas.

BRUCE WOOD

One Christmas Eve, says William Barclay, an Englishman called Julian Arnold was staying by himself in Edinburgh. Towards evening he was walking along Princes Street and felt very much alone. He came to a brightly lit restaurant, went in, sat by himself at a table for two and started to eat what he called a 'lonely dinner'. At the end of his meal he called the waiter over and asked for his bill. The waiter said to him, "Sir, a gentleman sitting at a table nearby instructed me to tell you that he gathered you were a stranger in our city and therefore he had ventured to give himself the honour of being your unknown host upon this Christmas Eve. He hoped that you would pardon this wish of his to offer you his own good wishes and the courtesy of his country."

The poet Wordsworth said that a boy grew up "as

First Aid Competition 1977

This competition took place at the Woking Youth Centre on Sunday, 23rd October, 1977. Each member of a team of four did an individual test, and then all combined to do a team test. There were some highly skilled people from St. John's and the Post Office acting as Judges and casualties etc. which made the competition very realistic, and even seemed to frighten the County Commissioner, Gordon Bates!

The really disappointing fact was that out of all the Units in Surrey, only eight entered, and only five turned up on the day. This surely means that Venture Scouts in Surrey do very little First Aid, which in turn leads us to believe that we are not prepared to give this most valuable service to other members of our community.

Unit members and leaders are invited by the Judges to a demonstration of First Aid Competition incidents. If you are interested, please contact Bruce Wood (A.C.C.(VS)).

The Competition Results are as follows:-

1st place:	Royal Grammar School - Guildford	200½ marks
2nd place:	Ewell Spring Mixed Unit - Ewell	190½ marks
3rd place:	Juno Venture Scout Unit - Woking	188½ marks
Best individual test 1 & 3 -	Colin Thomas - Ewell Spring Mixed Unit	42½ marks
Best individual test 2 & 4 -	Tim Purdue - Ewell Spring Mixed Unit	44 marks

TIM BENSON

(Competition Chairman)

if his whole vocation were endless imitation". One of our responsibilities as leaders is to try to provide something that is worth imitating and in doing this I can think of two things that will help. One is a good story, preferably a true one; the other is personal example. If it is true that not everyone can tell a good story, it is equally true that anyone can give a good example.

The act of kindness illustrated above would seem to have been done in the same spirit that prompted an unknown Scout to help William Boyce through a thick London fog in 1909. Some of the customs surrounding the celebration of the birth of Christ are timely reminders that a Scout is friendly and considerate.

BARRY ANDERSON

County Commissioner

Browsing through the pages of that excellent little book "The Scout Group", published last year and essential reading for all G.S.L.s and Scouters-in-charge, I was reminded that during the first twenty years of Scouting, each Pack and Troop was an independent unit. The Group structure was not introduced until 1927. That was fifty years ago. Nevertheless, another passage in the same book reads: "To look at some groups you would think that the Scouters were not speaking terms with one another, for they never seem to meet"! Does that ring true? Even here in Surrey? If so, such a Group is heading for real trouble!

At recent conferences, with widely differing membership, I have noticed that one message above all is coming over loud and clear: "Scout Leaders won't know what has hit them when the present generation of Cub Scouts, who have acquired quite a wide range of interests and skills through the developed Arrow Scheme, go up into the Troop!" That statement must be qualified, though, by saying it only applies to those Scout Leaders who don't bother to find out what is going on in the Pack!

There should be no cause for concern where the Group system is working properly. By that I mean where meetings of all warranted Scouters in the Group are held regularly.

To quote from Rule 14 of POR:

- (i) The Group Scouters' meeting is held as frequently as possible and is led by the Group Scout Leader. Its purpose is to:
 - concern itself with the well-being and development of each member of the Group;
 - ensure the progress and continuity of all training in the Group;
 - plan and co-ordinate all the Group's activities;
 - keep the Group Executive Committee advised of the financial requirements of the training programme.
- (ii) All warrant holders and the Chairman of the Executive Committee of any Venture Scout Unit in the Group may attend the Group Scouters' Meetings.

The Scouters' Meeting is the natural forum in which the Cub Scout Leaders can keep other Leaders in the Group briefed on what is happening in the Pack - especially under the developed Arrow Scheme. The Scout Leaders can then ensure that when the Cub Scouts do eventually go up into the Troop they

will find continuity of training awaiting them in an exciting programme of activities which leads them on from where they left off in the Pack. Scout Leaders can also make preparations for this by establishing the right contacts with experts outside the Group, who will be ready to help with the wide range of activities which will be required.

It is interesting to note that there is a growing trend for more Groups to have their own Venture Unit. Here too, the Unit Leaders (and the Chairman of the Unit Executive) will need to know all about the state of training of the Scouts going on up into the Unit. There must be no break in continuity here either if Venture Scouts are going to gain first their Venture Award and then, the ultimate goal, the Queen's Scout Award.

Hopefully, the majority of Groups in the County hold such Scouters' meetings regularly already. Splendid - keep it up! But where this is not happening it is the responsibility of the G.S.L. or Scouter-in-charge to make sure that such meetings start being held regularly as a matter of real urgency. He, or she, should rightly expect to receive no peace from the other Leaders in the Group until meetings are a regular feature of the Group's calendar! We claim that Scouting is a progressive Movement, keeping up with modern trends, education and the development of young people. So it is, but there are still a few Scouters who would like time to stand still hoping that the programmes they ran ten years ago or so will suffice today. They won't. Young people are impatient and anxious to get on. The pace is quickening. Leaders must help one another to keep abreast of the times. The proper forum is a regular Group Scouters' meeting. Please use it.

A warm welcome to Scouting in Surrey is extended to Lt. Col. D.G. Wilson, T.D., J.P., D.L., who has accepted my invitation to become District Commissioner for Reigate. Desmond Wilson will take up his appointment on 1st March 1978. In the meantime Peter Lankester, our Field Commissioner, will continue to be acting D.C. for Reigate as he has been for the past year.

Finally as this eventful year draws to a close, my wife joins me in wishing all readers of "Surrey Scout" a very happy Christmas and a happy New Year.

GORDON BATES

Pieces and Bits

Lotteries and Amusements Act 1976.

Certain changes came about when this Act came into force which effect lotteries (this term includes raffles and draws.) The following points should therefore be taken into account by Groups when using these means for fund raising.

1. It is necessary for each individual Scout Group to register with the Local Authority. Umbrella cover by the District is no longer permissible.
2. A new scale of registration fees applies and fees are payable on the first of January each year as follows: £10 for the first year of registration and £5 for each subsequent renewal.
3. The various categories of Lottery are:
 - a. A small lottery incidental to an exempt entertainment e.g. a raffle run at a Bazaar where all the tickets are sold in a single day, with the draw taking place on that day. (This type of raffle can be run without the need of registration).
 - b. A Private Lottery e.g. A 200 Club, where membership is restricted to the members of the larger organisation.
 - c. A Society's Lottery - this is the ordinary type of Draw where the proceeds must go to the named charity and the public may participate.
 - d. The Local Lottery which may now be run by Local Authorities.

Further information can be obtained from the Legal Department of the Scout Association.

PETER LANKESTER

Scouts

1977 County Patrol & Camping Competition

With this issue of "Surrey Scout", a separate copy of the Judges' Report is being distributed to each Scout Leader. Even though your Troop may not have had a patrol in this competition, it is well worth reading.

BRIAN PARKER

1977 Swimming Gala

It was good to see such an entry for this Annual event - 76 Cub Scout Teams out of a possible 80, 130 Scout Teams out of a possible 140 but only 28 Venture Scout Teams out of a possible 80. Particular thanks go to Ray Crosbie who organised the event, Brian Parker and Don Plumley who did the score-keeping and very special thanks to Guildford Swimming Club who provided the judges.

Results were: Cub Scouts - 1st. Godalming, 2nd. Farnham and 3rd. Walton & Weybridge. Scouts - 1st. Staines, 2nd. Ewell and 3rd. Guildford and Woking. Venture Scouts - 1st. Woking, 2nd. Staines, 3rd. Ewell. Overall winners were Staines, runners-up Ewell and 3rd. Woking.

50 Years

1st West Ewell Group is anxious to hear from anyone who has ever been connected with that Group at any time since 1928 when it was first formed. Photographs, uniforms, badges are required for exhibition. If you know anyone, please ask him to contact Mr. L. Jaques on 01-393 6122.

Operation Triangle '78

The East Grinstead District have kindly invited any Surrey Venture Scouts to take part in Operation Triangle '78 on 25th/26th February. Further details from P.R. Conquest, 25 Holtye Avenue, East Grinstead, Sussex, large S.A.E. please.

Sinbad the Sailor

That is the title of the 8th Annual Show of East Surrey District, to be held at the Notre Dame Convent School, St. Pier's Lane, Lingfield on 10th and 11th February. Tickets are available from A.J. Osborn, 4 Broadbridge Cottages, Broadbridge Lane, Smallfield, Horley, Surrey.

Any Others?

That's up to you. If you are organising something and you want to tell all the County about it; send details to the editor and every effort will be made to include those details in "Surrey Scout". Only one plea - please be sure to send the details in plenty of time.

**A Very Happy Christmas
to all our Readers**

Cub Scouts

As another year draws to its close, we look back to review what we have achieved and look forward to plan another year of exciting activities repeating past successes and learning from past failures. I hope that all teams of Pack Scouters will spend some time on such a review and that they will, of course, liaise with their other section Scouters in the Group to ensure that the whole of the Group's activities are co-ordinated and that the training section activities do provide for proper progression as the boy grows older.

The most burning topic of the past year has been the introduction of the Developed Arrow Scheme - I know that there are many who have reservations - many who feel that the developments make the Pack Scouters job more difficult. To those I do say please take heart from the fact that the experience of those who have started to work the scheme is that it is

much more meaningful to the boy and that many of our fears from reading the scheme do not materialise in practice. Remember that we do have two years in which to convert, that each Pack can convert when it is convenient to it, that "flexibility" is the keyword and that careful preparation and planning for the actual conversion is essential. Remember also that your District and County teams are there to help and advise you.

Let us, therefore, look forward with confidence and enthusiasm.

Mary, Simon and Timothy join me in wishing you all a Very Happy Christmas and every Blessing for you and your family.

DEREK BASSETT

Leader Training Courses

General Information Course

Twickenham 2nd & 9th December

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Guildford 3rd/4th December
East Surrey 14th/15th January, 1978
Surbiton 28th/29th January, 1978
Croydon 11th/12th February, 1978
Woking 18th/19th February, 1978

Merton 4th/5th March, 1978
The following additional courses are planned
Sutton March, 1978

SCOUT LEADERS

Reigate 14th/15th January, 1978
Surbiton 25th/26th February, 1978
Bentley Copse (residential) 18th/19th March, 1978

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 4th/5th March, 1978

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

To be announced 4th/5th February, 1978

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 20th/21st & 27th/29th May

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 3rd/4th, 17th/18th June & 1st/2nd July

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse Autumn 1978

G.S.L.s/COMMISSIONERS

Bentley Copse

R. Micklefield, 66 Godfrey Ave., Twickenham.

R. Penfold, 49 Wolverton Gardens, Horley.
B. Brown, 21, Langsmead, Blindley Heath, Lingfield.
S.J. Street, 15, Summerville Gardens, Cheam.
Mrs. M. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.
Mrs. J. Fentiman, "Woodside", Meadow Way, Great Bookham.

Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.

S. Street, 15, Summerville Gardens, Cheam.

J.M. Elliot, 22, Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne.
D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

R.D. Wood, 2, Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Great Bookham.

E.J. Walden, 31, Langton Way, Croydon.

F. Fentiman, "Woodside", Meadow Way, Great Bookham

R.D. Wood, 2, Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley.

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Great Bookham.

D. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Scout Fellowship

I am pleased to be able to report that two more Districts, Guildford and Dorking, are in the process of setting up Scout Fellowships, and we wish them every success.

At the recent A.C.C. (Fellowship) National Conference, it was interesting to note that of the total Fellowship membership in the 41 Counties represented, from England and Wales, Surrey formed 16.8%. So we are well to the forefront of the counties where this new idea is gaining a very firm foothold.

Scout Fellowship members who are full members of the Association are automatically members of the International Fellowship of Former Scouts & Guides (IFOFSAG). It is hoped that in the future we will be able to foster International exchanges etc., through this organisation. I shall be circulating details of IFOFSAG, its aims, administration etc., but in the meantime there is available The International Fellowship Bulletin, etc., annual subscription 85p per annum. If you would like to regularly receive a copy, please let me have your remittance before **THIS** Christmas. Still on the international front IFOFSAG have a regional meeting 20th - 24th April, 1978 in the Netherlands (near Utrecht). The programme is very full and varied. Any District Fellowships inter-

ted, please contact me for further details.

Other items of interest:-

a) H.Q. have produced a standard Fellowship members application and record form. Samples will be distributed to Districts shortly. Issue is free, but use not compulsory.

b) The Fellowship Chalet at Gilwell is available for our use. I will be pleased to supply details if you are interested. This well appointed Chalet is especially recommended for family use.

c) Please note in your diary - Gilwell Fellowship Weekend - 16th - 18th June 1978.

At the A.C.C.s conference previously mentioned the following Fellowship Prayer was introduced. I recommend it for use at your own District Fellowship meetings:

"Eternal Father, we ask your blessing on all those who honour you and serve their fellow men in the Scout Fellowship. Make them generous in sharing their experience with others in our movement. By their example, courage and loyalty, may they bring to bear the influence and spirit of our Founder. We ask this through your Son, Jesus Christ our Lord."

ERIC MACKIE

Congratulations

CHIEF SCOUT'S COMMENDATION FOR GOOD SERVICES

D. F. Gill, Group Treasurer, 1st Chiddingfold

LONG SERVICE DECORATION

D. Brown, A.D.C.(L.T.) East Surrey.

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Michael Anderson	1st Hedgecourt
Clifford Ansell	1st Molesey
Howard Bailey	3rd Epsom
Simon Bennett	Oatlands
Ian Boyd	1st Molesey
Guy Compton	5th Dorking
Justin Darnell	1st Hedgecourt
Bobby Howell	5th Dorking
Michael Partridge	SS Peter and Paul, Godalming
Kevin Poplett	7th Epsom
Christopher Richardson	1st Old Woking
Brian Rothwell	5th Dorking
Andrew Scott	1st Hedgecourt
Phillip Taylor	1st/4th Addlestone
Craig Timperley	5th Amberley
Nicholas Troughton	The Dittons
Philip Tull	All Saints, 1st New Haw
Charles Westbrook	3rd Epsom
Simon Wright	22nd Dorking

County Diary

December

1	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
12	Finance Committee	Leatherhead
13	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Cuddington

1978

January

11	County Executive	B.-P. House
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February

5	District Officials' Conference	Dorking
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March

2	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
11	Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee	West Ewell

June

1	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
2	County A.G.M.	Esher

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